

THREE'S COMPANY
(From left) Roman Saini, Gaurav Munjal and Hemesh Singh

NAVEEN KADAM

MAKING A MARK

GAURAV MUNJAL, 31
ROMAN SAINI, 30
HEMESH SINGH, 29

Co-founders, Unacademy, **Bengaluru**

"My aspiration is to be the biggest [start-up] in the world, and build one of the largest consumer internet firms India has seen"

GAURAV MUNJAL

While in school, an engineering coaching centre had rejected Gaurav Munjal, saying he could not be put in the batch taught by the best teachers. Munjal realised how good education was a privilege in India. In 2010, while in college, he started Unacademy as an educational channel on YouTube. Its popularity led to Unacademy's formal launch in 2015. Munjal's first venture, however, was Flat.to, a real estate platform co-founded with Hemesh Singh in 2013. It was acquired by commonfloor.com. Unacademy aims to build the world's largest learning repository on the 'freemium business model'. Learners can access courses for free but pay a subscription for live classes and personalised learning. In a short span, Unacademy has gained over 50,000 registered educators and over 49 million learners. The group entered the unicorn club in 2020 and, according to Venture Intelligence, is currently valued at $3.4 billion (Rs 25,770 crore). ■

–M.G. Arun

LIKE MINDS Munjal is passionate about technology and building world-class products. Singh enjoys writing code and travelling. Saini, a doctor who cleared the IAS, was an assistant collector in MP